

Risk Register — Likelihood & Severity Scoring

Activity — Score Risks Based on Their Likelihood and Severity | Bank Scenario

Operating Environment

The bank is located in a coastal area with low crime rates. 100 on-premise and 20 remote employees handle the bank's data. The customer base includes 2,000 individual and 200 commercial accounts. Bank services are marketed by a professional sports team and ten local businesses. Strict financial regulations require the bank to maintain sufficient daily funds to meet Federal Reserve requirements.

Risk Factors — Notes

The bank's coastal location creates exposure to supply chain disruptions from weather events, despite the area's low crime rate. With remote workers, a large commercially connected customer base, and strict regulatory obligations, even low-frequency security events can carry severe financial and compliance consequences. Holding financial records for 2,200+ customers makes the bank a high-value target for data exfiltration, social engineering, and ransomware attacks.

Scoring Scale

Score	Likelihood	Severity
1	Low — unlikely (e.g., once a year)	Low — minimal impact
2	Moderate — could occur occasionally	Moderate — notable harm, recoverable
3	High — likely or frequent occurrence	High — major impact on operations/compliance

Risk Assessment Register

Risk	Description	Notes	Like- lihood	Sev- erity	Score
Business Email Compromise	Phishing/spear-phishing causes an employee to transfer funds or disclose credentials to an attacker impersonating a senior executive or vendor.	Remote workers increase likelihood; lack of in-person verification makes BEC harder to detect in time.	2	3	6
Compromised User Database	Attacker gains unauthorized access to the customer database, exfiltrating personal and financial records of 2,200+ accounts.	High-value target due to commercial accounts; breach triggers mandatory regulatory disclosure and heavy fines.	2	3	6

Risk	Description	Notes	Like-likelihood	Sev-erity	Score
Financial Records Leak	Sensitive financial data exposed via misconfigured storage, insider action, or a third-party vendor breach.	Sports team and local business partnerships expand the third-party attack surface significantly.	2	3	6
Theft	Physical theft of devices, cash, or documents from premises by an employee or external actor.	Low crime area reduces likelihood; insider theft of digital assets (e.g., USB) remains a concern.	1	2	2
Supply Chain Attack	A coastal weather event (hurricane) disrupts the bank's supply chain, preventing it from replenishing funds to meet Federal Reserve requirements.	Coastal location makes this a realistic environmental risk; consequences include regulatory penalty.	1	3	3

Priority Summary

Risk	Score	Priority	Recommended Action
Business Email Compromise	6	HIGH	Deploy DMARC/DKIM/SPF; phishing simulation training for all staff
Compromised User Database	6	HIGH	Encrypt database; enforce MFA and RBAC; restrict remote access
Financial Records Leak	6	HIGH	Audit third-party access; apply DLP controls; classify all data
Supply Chain Attack	3	MEDIUM	Document business continuity and disaster recovery procedures
Theft	2	LOW	Maintain physical security controls; enforce clear-desk and device policies